

TIMELINE

May 29, 1917 Born in Brookline, Massachusetts, son of Rose Fitzgerald Kennedy and Joseph Patrick Kennedy.

1927 Family moves to New York City.

1931–34 Attends the Choate School at Wallingford, Connecticut.

June 1940 Graduates from Harvard.

September 1941 Joins the US Naval Reserve, serving in World War II.

August 2, 1943 Japanese sink *PT-109*, the Motor Torpedo Boat commanded by Kennedy; he is later decorated for bravery.

August 12, 1944 Elder brother Joe Kennedy Jr. is killed on a flying mission.

1946 Elected to the House of Representatives for Massachusetts's 11th Congressional District; reelected 1948 and 1950.

1952 Elected senator for Massachusetts; reelected 1958.

September 12, 1953 Marries Jacqueline (Jackie) Bouvier.

1954 Undergoes major spinal surgery.

1956 Narrowly misses selection as a vice-presidential candidate at the Democratic Convention.

November 27, 1957 Birth of daughter Caroline; son John Jr. born November 25, 1960; son Patrick born August 7, 1963, but dies two days later.



KENNEDY WITH DAUGHTER CAROLINE, WIFE JACKIE, AND SON JOHN JR.

November 1960 Elected president.

January 20, 1961 Sworn in as 35th president of the United States.

April 1961 The Bay of Pigs invasion of Cuba.

May 1961 Sends Green Berets as special advisers to South Vietnam.

June 1961 Agrees to a ceasefire in Laos with Soviet leader Nikita Khrushchev.

October 1961 Sends more advisers to South Vietnam.

October 1962 Achieves the withdrawal of Soviet nuclear missiles from Cuba.